

AAC foundations, *for the team.*

A quick reference for everyone supporting a student who uses Proloquo2Go.

1. **Her device goes everywhere she goes** — class, home, therapy, the bus.
2. **Everyone uses it** — every adult, every setting.
3. **It is never taken away** — not as a consequence, not during a test.
4. **It is available during every assessment** — testing without it measures the barrier, not the student.

1 What AAC is, and presuming competence

AAC is **everything but speech** — the device, signs, gestures, pointing all count. The mindset under all of it: **presume competence**. Assume she understands and has something to say. There are no prerequisites for a voice; access comes first, and skills grow from use.

2 Motor planning & grid size

A fluent user finds a word by muscle memory — but only if it stays in the same place. So core words stay put, changes are planned, and you **hide words rather than move them**.

Bigger grid, revealed gradually — not a tiny one. There's no evidence for starting with only a few buttons; a small grid caps language and forces constant navigation. Choose the largest grid she can accurately see and touch, and use **Progressive Language** to hide extra words without moving the ones she knows.

3 Editing Proloquo2Go safely

- Add the words she loves (people, foods, characters)
- Keep core where it lives — add fringe, don't relocate core
- Reveal with Progressive Language; don't shrink or rebuild
- Back up after every change (iCloud, Drive, Dropbox)

4 Modeling — the one skill that matters most

Talk while touching the words. Touch one or two key words as you say them, model to show rather than quiz, and model then wait a silent ten. Nobody has to speak to be modeled to. This is **aided language input**, and it's how she learns where words live and what they do.



The VOICE check — five seconds, every setting. Visible, On, In reach, Charged, Every setting. It can't be her voice in a backpack.

Academics & behavior.

A voice for learning, and keeping communication open when things get hard.

5 Academic access

Requesting is the floor, not the ceiling. A device that only asks for snacks and breaks is a remote control; a voice lets her comment, question, compare, and object about what she's learning. And one core word does academic work everywhere — "more" in math and science and snack, "different," "change," "why," "not" across any subject. She doesn't need a new word for each lesson. Presume she has something to say, and give her the words to say it.

6 Behavior is communication

Every challenging behavior is a message: escape means "I need out," attention means "talk to me," tangible means "I want that," sensory means "too much." Teach the word and the behavior loses its job — that's functional communication training, and honoring the message is teaching a replacement, not giving in.

When it escalates: stop talking (three words or fewer), model don't demand, and honor the message in any form, every time.

A low-tech backup: when the device is out of reach or she's too dysregulated to navigate it, a printed de-escalation board keeps a channel open — point to stop, break, help, all done. It's a bridge, never a replacement for her device. One per grade band is on the resource page.

7 What we each carry

Everyone models daily, in every setting. The team keeps the device out and available always — including during work and assessment — and never takes it away. The device gets a VOICE check in every setting, a robust and consistent layout, and a backup. And all of us presume competence. **She is already communicating; our job is to make sure someone is always ready to listen.**